Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)	**History**		
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)		Interdisciplinary framework:	
Research question:	**How significant was the 1968 Tet Offensive in causing US failure in the Vietnam War?**		
Assessment details			
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)	
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	The research question is relevant to the topic and has some focus, but it is too broad. To consider why the USA failed in the Vietnam War is a massive subject for consideration, encompassing many factors. The research methods are mostly suitable to the research question and are applied with partial effectiveness. The structural conventions support some aspects.	
B: Knowledge and understanding [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**4**	Some relevant research materials are used to establish some knowledge about the stated factor; the Tet Offensive and some other factors; guerilla warfare, Operation Rolling Thunder. Some relevant terminology is accurately used to demonstrate partial understanding of some aspects of the subject matter. Some relevant concepts are explained and used with partial effectiveness.	
C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**3**	While sections of the essay are descriptive there is some analysis that is partially effective and produces relevant findings. A partial line of argument is present.	
D: Discussion and evaluation [Maximum possible mark: 8]	**4**	There is an attempt to consider the stated factor against other factors. The discussion is partially balanced with some attempts at evaluation.	
E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**1**	The reflection is descriptive of the learning experience, and descriptive of the process. (The reflection is significantly below the word count.)	
Total marks awarded	16/30		
Holistic comment on the essay:	The candidate has a given some consideration to the stated factor and tried to balance it against two other factors. This has produce a limited consideration of the reason for USA failure in the Vietnam War. The three factors are described but there is also some attempts to consider their significance.		